**It’s Enough, For Now**

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# It’s Enough, For Now

by Kittyrosee

Summary

Katsuki shrugged his shoulders and turned back around to open the door. His hands grasped the golden handle of the towering door, finally pushing the door open.

Curls. Freckles.Green.

Katsuki’s eyes widened in shock, his backpack falling unceremoniously to the flood with a loud thud that echoed through the room as the breath escaped his lungs.

“...Izuku?”

Or

The reunion

Notes

Please read the tags for trigger warnings!

The sound of pacing footsteps had become common background noise over the last week in the Aizawa-Yamada household. Despite their best efforts, it seemed Izuku was fated to wallow in his stress until the exam results arrived. Anyone who knew Izuku knew he was a chronic overthinker, so it came as no shock to anyone that immediately following his entrance exams, his brain had instantly begun to review every step he made and criticize it. What if he had done this instead of this? Why had he said that? That sounds so stupid Izuku! What if they just flat out refused him because of his quirklessness?

His dads had reassured him many times that the staff at UA were nothing like his previous schools; they would treat him with the same candor as any other student. Logically, the 14 year old knew this, he had met his dad's co-workers plenty of times since being adopted. They all adored him and made it a point to vocalize such. But 16 months of acceptance didn't erase 8 years of torment from those in their exact positions of power. To Izuku, they weren't just pro heroes he idolized, they were teachers; and teachers had never been kind to Izuku.

His trauma and logic were at war, and it was looking as though that war wouldn't halt until Izuku was holding that letter in his own two hands.

Aside from his own feelings on the matter, objectively speaking Izuku's entrance exam had gone well. He had taken the recommendation exam upon his fathers' request, although he tried to deny them at first. Their main source of reasoning was that if Izuku were to attend the normal exam, he would be surrounded by hundreds of student hopefuls, and that he would probably have a much easier time focusing in a more isolated environment. Which, alright, they had a fair point. He wasn't quite ready to re-enter big social environments again.

Both of his dads were confident in his skills, having been the ones to train him over the last year. Aizawa had pushed him especially hard, knowing that in the end, Izuku's fighting style would emulate his more than Hizashi's. Shouta had a quirk that aided him in the field, yes, but when it came down to it he relied on quirkless combat when in battle the same way Izuku would learn to.

It surprised Shouta how quickly Izuku took to all of it, not that he didn't think he was capable. But it had only been just under a year and Izuku had already pretty much mastered the art of knife throwing.

At some point 7 months in, Shouta had walked into the backyard only to find his 13 year old son blindfolded with 2 knives in his right hand, sharpened blades glinting in the sunlight. His back was turned, facing the complete opposite direction of the targets. A wave of panic washed over him, but before he'd had a chance to cry out, Izuku whipped around. The look of pure focus stayed set on Izuku's face as both knives struck solidly into the wood. Both perfectly in the center bullseye. Izuku lifted his blindfold with a deep breath and gazed upon the results of his throw. To Shouta's surprise, a disappointed glare spread across the greenettes face, grumbling to himself as he approached the target to retrieve his weapons.

"Izuku?" Shouta asked quietly.

Startling, Izuku jumped, his shoulders relaxing once he laid his eyes on his father. “Yeah?” He replied.

“What the hell was that?”

A look of confusion crossed Izuku’s face before he looked down at his hands where his knives were held, his eyes clearing up with understanding.

“Oh! I was just practicing!” He smiled. “I’m still a little off, but I'll keep working on it.”

As strange as this was, Shouta would never tire of seeing that look on his son's face. Pure determination shone in his eyes, emerald alight with a fire that had been non-existent just a year prior.

The reality was, although Izuku had made great progress in his physical recovery following his year of homelessness, Izuku was still underweight by some pounds. He wasn’t that strong physically yet, but what he lacked in muscle was easily made up for in speed and agility. Izuku was slippery, darting between legs and under punches easily. Shouta and Hizashi figured it was a skill he had been forced to learn early. They knew of his past with bullies and they can only imagine the kind of people he must have encountered on the streets. Although not through ideal circumstances, running and dodging were already second nature to Izuku.

Another skill they had noticed his proficiency in was stealth. Izuku was very quiet when he wanted to be. His feet barely made a sound as he walked, and more than once he had accidentally terrified one of his dads’ by sneaking up on them. He apologized and cried for 30 minutes after causing Hizashi to drop his favorite mug.

The air in the Aizawa-Yamada house didn’t settle until 10 days after the exam when Izuku’s results finally arrived.

No one but Izuku was surprised when he got in. Still, they held him close and told him how proud they were as he cried tears of joy, thanking them for giving him a chance.

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There was a nervous tingle that cascaded down Katsuki’s spine as he walked through the pristine halls of UA High. All of that studying. All of the training and therapy. It had all paid off. He’d made it. Still, the scowl of casual indifference rested unwavering on his face, his footsteps meshing in with those of the other bright-eyed students searching for their own classrooms.

Izuku’s voice echoed in the back of his mind as he walked. Their dream was here, Katsuki was going to become a hero for the both of them. He would make Izuku proud.

He’d changed so much. The old him seemed like such a distant memory, yet it was as though no time had passed at all. How had it already been almost 2 years since that day, when his whole world had come crashing down around him. The thought that Izuku’s death had been what it had taken to see the error of his ways always made the bile rise to burn Katsuki’s throat.

Katsuki swallowed it down, dismissing the thought. He'd been a terrible person, yes, but he wasn't anymore. The old hag had been right. There was good inside of Katsuki, and now that he'd finally found it, he'd never lose it again.

Rounding the corner, the sight of a door stretching all the way to the ceiling loomed in front of the blonde, a shiny red '1A' pasted to the front. Katsuki took a deep breath in before his thoughts were abruptly interrupted by a loud voice from behind him.

"Hey it's you! Explosion boy!" A feminine voice said behind him.

Turning over his shoulder, Katsuki saw the short form of the very girl he'd saved at the entrance exam.

"Oh, it's you." Katsuki said simply.

"It's so cool we both made it in! I was hoping you would!" She said, shaking her fists excitedly.

Katsuki raised a single brow at the girl's exclamation. "You were?" He deadpanned.

"Yeah! I didn't get a chance to thank you for saving me. And I felt really bad that you probably lost out on earning extra points because of me." The girl said, scuffing her shoe nervously. "Oh! I'm Ochaco Uraraka by the way!" She smiled, holding out a hand for Katsuki to shake.

Katsuki looked down at her blushing form, her hand still outstretched and welcoming for him to take. "Katsuki Bakugou." He replied plainly, his own hand reaching out to shake hers. "And don't worry about it, I still placed 1st in the exam so it was no skin off my back."

Her eyes widened in surprise as her mouth dropped open at his statement. "First?!" She exclaimed. "That's amazing! So cool!"

Ignoring the pleased tingle that radiated through him at the girl's praise, Katsuki shrugged his shoulders and turned back around to open the door. His hands grasped the golden handle of the towering door, finally pushing the door open.

Curls.

Freckles.

Green.

Katsuki's eyes widened in shock, his backpack falling unceremoniously to the flood with a loud thud that echoed through the room as the breath escaped his lungs.

"...Izuku?"

The boy in question turned his head from where he'd been speaking quietly with one of the other students. A boy with spiked red hair and sharpened teeth. A confused look crossed his face before his own eyes widened in recognition.

“Oh.” He breathed out, his eyes scanning Katsuki’s frozen form.

Red eyes burned hot as tears began to form, Katsuki’s feet shakily stepping forward. He felt like he was seeing a ghost, although in a way he supposed he was. He looked the boy over as he approached. He was different from what Katuski remembered. He was taller, only shorter than Katsuki himself by a few inches now. And he was stronger, his shoulders slightly broader and a thin layer of muscle now toned his previously scrawny form. He was still thin, but he seemed healthier now. Despite the changes, there was no mistaking it. Izuku was here.

“Y-you're alive?” Katsuki whispered, reaching his hand out hesitantly to gently graze Izuku’s shoulder. He jolted back slightly upon feeling the solid mass of a person, having almost expected his hand to pass right through. Izuku himself startled at the contact, his eyebrows furrowed in confusion as his body stood on guard. “You’re…”

A single tear fell down Katsuki’s cheek as he suddenly lurched forward, enveloping the long lost boy in a crushing hug. He couldn’t even feel embarrassment over his emotional display, too focused on actually feeling the weight of Izuku in his arms when he’d finally accepted that he’d never be able to again. Katsuki could feel the eyes of his classmates on his back, but none of that mattered right now. He could show them his strength later. Who cared about being the best when Izuku was alive and right in front of him.

Izuku jumped as his childhood friend turned bully suddenly wrapped his arms around him, a squeak of surprise leaving his throat as he felt a wet patch begin to form on his shoulder where Katsuki’s face was pressed. Trembling hands clutched desperately at the back of Izuku’s blazer as the blonde embraced him.

Izuku had known there was a likely possibility that Katsuki would show up at UA. He’d prepared himself for every reaction he could imagine Katsuki would have. He’d prepared for yelling, screaming, even fighting. He’d practiced what to say should Katsuki question his position in the hero course. Izuku had lost count of the amount of fake conversations he’d had with himself where Katsuki would berate him for thinking he was better than him by even daring to apply to the same school. He was ready to stand up to his former tormentor and prove that he deserved to stand on the same ground he did.

The last thing Izuku had expected was tears. He’d never in a million years imagined Katsuki might actually be, Happy? To see him. That he would be so gentle as to cradle Izuku in his arms as though he were the most precious thing to exist.

Raising his own unsure hand up, Izuku awkwardly patted Katsuki’s back as the other boy grasped him like a lifeline. His eyes scanned the room, meeting gazes of each of his very confused new classmates.

“K-Kacchan?” He asked, the name suddenly causing the boy wrapped around him to let out a shuddering sob. “What is happening?” Izuku whispered to himself.

Finally, Katsuki peeled himself off of Izuku’s very confused form. His cheeks now shining slightly with the remnants of his tears as his bloodshot red eyes looked down at Izuku’s own.

“I'm so sorry.” Katsuki whispered, his hands still planted firmly on Izuku’s shoulders, looking Izuku square in the eyes. He said those 3 words to Izuku like he’d never have the chance to again.

Katsuki’s words echoed in Izuku’s head before a wave of realization crashed down on him.

“Wha-” Katsuki said as Izuku suddenly grasped his wrist, abruptly pulling him forward and dragging the blonde out of the room and back into the hall, slamming the door behind them. Izuku marched forward, navigating the familiar halls easily before suddenly shoving Katsuki forward into a small bathroom, locking the door behind them.

In the small space of the bathroom, Katsuki’s mind continued reeling. So much was happening. So much didn’t make sense. Izuku was here. At UA. He was alive. Izuku’s back faced Katsuki, his hand still resting on the lock, composing himself with deep breaths.

“I thought you were-”

“Dead?” Izuku interrupted. His emotionless tone echoed across the room and he turned his head to face the blonde.

Katsuki gaped for a moment before snapping his mouth shut and shakily nodding.

“I almost was.” Izuku declared bluntly. “A hero found me on the roof, beaten and sitting on the edge. He talked me down, took me home, and long story short now he’s my dad.”

Izuku shrugged his shoulders, casually indifferent as he admitted to nearly killing himself all those nights ago. Izuku had coped with it, accepted it, and moved on. He wasn’t the same kid that sat on that rooftop anymore.

Turning fully, Izuku gaged Katsuki’s reactions. The other boy stood wide eyed, his hands hanging limply at his sides, trembling. Silent tears streaked down his cheeks still; Izuku didn’t think he’d seen Katsuki cry so much in all the years he’d known him. It was confusing. He’d expected explosions, to be attacked and insulted by the other boy. Not whatever this was.

Katsuki’s mouth opened, small grunts escaping as he fought to speak clearly.

“I-I mean you…And I just..” He stammered, his shaking hands raising and beginning to gesture in emphasis. “Y-you didn’t come back. After what I-I said to you.”

“I thought that’s what you wanted.” Izuku said clearly, bringing his own trembling hands to hide within the protective confines of his pockets. “You hated me Kacchan.” His voice cracked traitorously.

“I..”

There was a pause.

“Everything changed. The day you didn’t show up to class. I kno-” Katsuki stumbled before correcting himself. “I knew you, you never missed school. I didn’t want to believe that you’d

actually done…that, but I couldn't think of another explanation."

In front of him, Izuku stood still, his attention focused solely on the blonde in front of him.

"It was my fucking fault. The thought of you being gone, It was like some kind of film got ripped away and for once I could actually see. You never did anything wrong, it was all me. I just.." Katsuki stuttered as his emotions threatened to interfere with his speech. He couldn't let them; and by some miracle, Katsuki had been granted a second chance. Izuku was standing in front of him, alive and well and breathing. He would not let himself fall apart before he apologized properly.

"It wasn't fair, the things I did to you. I acted like a villain. You never did anything wrong, you were just existing and I got it into my head that even that was above you. No one ever…I know it's not an excuse, the way other people encouraged me. I should have known to do better. To BE better."

Izuku stood, his shoulders shaking and his fingernails digging into pale skin from how hard he was clenching his fists. Still he stayed quiet knowing Katsuki wasn't done talking yet. He took in the strange new person inhabiting his old bully's body yet so like him it couldn't be anyone else. This was the Kacchan Izuku had missed all those years, the Kacchan that had been lost after Izuku didn't get his quirk.

"I didn't want to accept it. The news never said anything about a quirkless kid found d-dead" Katsuki shook his head clear "So I just kept looking for you. And after a few months, I just didn't have anywhere else to look. You were gone…and it was my fault."

Finally Katuski stopped his frantic pacing and turned towards Izuku again. His eyes were still teary and now rimmed red. Izuku was having trouble processing this turn of events. Katsuki had changed. Katsuki had looked for him; for months! He'd taken full responsibility for his participation in Izuku's attempt. In two years, Katsuki had transformed into someone Izuku had only dreamt about in his wildest fantasies.

Then, before a word could leave the boys' mouth, Katsuki took some steps forward, and dropped to his knees at Izuku's feet. His forehead rested against the floor tiles as he bowed at Izuku.

"I'm so sorry Izuku. For everything." He spoke, his clear voice echoing off of the bathroom walls. "You don't need to forgive me. You don't even need to acknowledge me. I just need you to know how sorry I am. I know I can't change the past but I promise, I'll never be that person again. If you want me to leave UA right now and never talk to you again, I'll do it!" Katsuki's voice cracked as he sniffed sharply. "Just please believe me when I say I'm so sorry. And that I'm so goddamn happy that you're here."

The sound of suppressed sobs and carefully controlled breathing echoed loudly in the boys' ears. Blonde spiked hair stuck uncomfortably between Katsuki's forehead and the cool tiled floor, yet he didn't dare move. Izuku looked down from his place towering over his old friend's kneeling form. He wanted to be angry. Izuku wanted to shout and fight and curse Katsuki in all the ways he'd done to him for so many years. He wanted to make him feel even a sliver of the hopelessness Izuku had lived with since 4 years old.

And yet he couldn't.

Because despite all of Katsuki's flaws and misdemeanors, Izuku could never hate him. Could never hurt him. Maybe that made him weak, for still caring so deeply about a person who'd brought him so much misery for so long. Still, Izuku could only be disconsolate that his friend had lost his way for so long. That society had cursed both of them with the expectations of their status and pushed them to equally damaging ideals. Katsuki and Izuku were two sides of the same disgusting coin. One cursed to claw for scraps from the bottom, the other fated to suffer from their existence on top. Maybe it wasn't the same, but Katsuki had been wronged just as well as Izuku had.

"Get up. This floor is disgusting." Izuku said, his foot moving forward to gently kick at Katsuki's still bowed head. Katsuki jolted, a small gasp of surprise leaving his mouth involuntarily. Slowly, he raised himself back to his knees, sitting back on his heels as he gazed up at spattered freckles he'd longed to see for so long. An expression of indifference rested on Izuku's face, his green eyes carefully concealed of emotion from where he now looked towards the mirror.

"You're right. You really sucked." He began. "I never cared if you were the strongest, or if you made it to the top someday. Your quirk could have disappeared and I still would have looked at you like the sun was shining out of your ass."

Katsuki balked in surprise. He'd never heard Izuku swear before.

"I just wanted my friend back." Izuku finished. It was like a punch to the gut to Katsuki, his chest filled with lead as more emotions surged through him.

"I'm sorry." Katsuki whispered. His head lowered in shame.

"I'm not the same person I was 2 years ago." Izuku began to speak again. Of course Katsuki knew this to be true, it was obvious enough by just looking at him. Despite the physical changes, there was an air of confidence that Katsuki had never seen Izuku carry with him. It made him proud to see that Izuku had come so far without Katsuki's own toxic behavior in his life. And yet he was also sad, a part of him wishing he'd been there to see his old friend become his better self.

"I'm not the same person I was 2 years ago." Izuku repeated. "But I can tell you aren't either."

Katsuki's eyes blew wide, his head snapped up to meet the shining emerald eyes now gazing down at him. Emerald eyes that now held a distinct sheen of moisture as they held back Izuku's own tears.

"I forgive you Kacchan."

More tears fell from Katsuki's eyes, sobs no longer able to be concealed as the words he'd dreamt of hearing for so long were actually spoken.

"Why?" He choked. "I don't deserve it. How can you even look at me and not hate me."

“I never hated you Kacchan. Even back then.” Izuku spoke. “And maybe you don’t deserve it. Maybe I’m making a mistake and you’ll hurt me again. But the way I see it, the Kacchan from before would have never been on his knees apologizing to anyone.”

There was a pause as Izuku finally removed his hands from where they had been pressed into his pockets. Katsuki’s lips quivered as a hand reached forward, open and waiting for Katsuki to take.

“Maybe forgiving you will blow up in my face, but as far as I'm concerned you’ve proven you’re at least worth the chance.”

At this, Katsuki finally raised his own hand to grip Izuku’s own and allowed the other boy to pull him to his feet. For a moment they just stood, hands clasped and staring at the other.

“I missed you Izuku.”

“Me too Kacchan.” Izuku replied with a soft smile. Then suddenly, with a sharp tug on his arm, Izuku pulled Katsuki forward, bringing his mouth up to the blonde's ear. “But if you pull anything ever again, I'm really good with knives now and I swear I will chop your goddamn hands off. Got it?”

Katsuki’s own eyes widened in alarm, immediately processing that Izuku was being 100% serious. He gulped nervously, suddenly very intimidated and maybe a little turned on by the shorter boy’s threat, But that was a thought for another time.

“Got it.” He replied shakily.

“Good!” Izuku exclaimed cheerfully, a wide toothed smile spreading across his face as he pulled back again. “The others should be down at the field already so we should hurry and meet them there, we still have to change into our PE uniforms.”

“What about orientation?” Katsuki replied dumbly, following behind Izuku as he opened the bathroom door and walked confidently through the halls.

“Dad thinks that's a waste of time, we’re starting the year off with a quirk assessment test.”

“Oh.” Katsuki replied dumbly. “But what about….I mean you..?”

“You don’t have to worry about me. Betcha I place in the top 10 even without one.” Izuku giggled, his hands back to resting casually in his pockets. It took Katsuki aback, this new confidence he’d never seen the other boy exude. Why had he ever tried to take this away from him? It was clear he was so much happier now, more sure of himself. There was no doubt in Izuku’s mind anymore that he had what it took to be a hero, that even without the tool the rest of them carried he was just as capable of kicking ass. It was a good look for him.

“Wait. Dad?” Katsuki suddenly realized.

“Oh yeah, I forgot to mention that. My name is Izuku Midoriya-Aizawa now. That hero I mentioned that adopted me, He’s our homeroom teacher.” Replied Izuku, turning to walk

backwards as he spoke. “Try not to get on his bad side, I’ve kind of told him all about you.” He said, a hand coming up to rub the back of his neck nervously.

“Oh….I’m completely fucked aren’t I?” Katsuki said, eyes widening as he processed the implications of what Izuku had said. His hero father was their new homeroom teacher, and he knew all about what Katsuki had done to his son. Katsuki wouldn’t be surprised if he was expelled the moment he walked onto the field.

“Mmm” Izuku shrugged nonchalantly.

Well that was reassuring.

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Walking onto the field, the rest of the class immediately turned their heads to stare at the new arrivals. It wasn’t surprising, Katsuki had caused quite the scene back in the classroom, he realized blushing.

“Midoriya. Bakugou. Thank you for joining us.” Aizawa said monotonously.

The moment Katsuki’s eyes landed on the man addressing them his blood immediately turned to ice. Oh shit. Oh SHIT! It was him. The hobo hero Katsuki had run into during his entrance exam. The one he’d spilled his guts to about how he’d bullied someone to irreversible consequences (Or so he’d thought). The same kid who turned out to BE HIS SON! Had Aizawa known when he’d met Katsuki who he was? That he’d been talking about Izuku? He couldn’t have, or else Katsuki never would have even been accepted. The blonde was snapped out of his inward spiral by the sound of his teacher’s voice.

“As I’m sure Midoriya has already briefed you, we’ll be going through a series of tests to assess the current limits of your abilities. None of the exercises you’ll encounter today will be new to you, however you are now permitted to use your quirk to assist you.” He said. The rest of the class nodded along, some reacting excitedly at the prospect of using their quirks so freely.

“Bakugou, you placed first in your practical exam. Catch.” Aizawa said, throwing a normal baseball to Katsuki which he stumbled to catch. “Come to the circle.”

Katsuki gulped, clenching his fists and approaching to stand in the middle of the white circle painted into the dirt.

“What was your record in middle school?” Aizawa asked.

“Umm. 67 meters I think.” Katsuki replied.

Katsuki turned his head slightly, looking to where Izuku was standing casually. His eyes were wide with confusion, confusion Izuku simply shrugged at.

“Try now using your quirk. Anything goes as long as you stand inside the circle.” His teacher stated, stepping off to the side.

Katsuki's hands shook as they tightened around the ball. He could do this. 'Show him you deserve to be here. Show him you've changed.' He thought. With a deep breath, His eyes steeled and he let out a loud cry, a booming explosion ringing in the ears of his classmates and he propelled the ball forward with all his strength.

The ball soared through the air before finally coming back down to earth. There was a beep from the machine in Aizawa's hands, the man turning it around to present the reading on the screen. The numbers 705.2 meters presented on the screen caused the rest of his classmates to erupt into excited chatter.

"Alright. Who's next?" The man smirked.

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The rest of the test passed by easily after that. Izuku had been correct in his statement from before, placing 8th overall amongst their classmates. Katsuki himself came in 3rd, just behind a stoic boy with two toned red and white hair, and a tall girl with a quirk so overpowered Katsuki was honestly a bit intimidated. At least he would be if she didn't seem so freaking nice.

Uraraka had done well, placing 10th. She'd come to ask if he was alright after the incident in the classroom.

"You don't have to tell me what happened, but are you okay?" She asked gently.

"It's a really long story that I'm not going to go into; but yeah I'm fine."

The rest of the class seemed to be almost wary of him, not quite sure what to think considering their first impression of him was to watch him break down and wrap himself desperately around one of their new classmates. They seemed to warm up a bit though after watching him in the tests.

Izuku had been nearly unrecognizable to Katsuki as he ran through his own tests. Sure he hadn't done great on some like the grip strength or the standing long jump, but Izuku had excelled beyond Katsuki's expectations in others. For starters, He was fast! Coming in the top 5 for the 50 meter dash. And he was flexible. Scarily so even. Not even wincing when folding himself in half during the seated toe touch. And the ball throw. That was hilarious.

"Midoriya." Aizawa called, the green haired boy moving forward and coming to the circle. Taking the offered ball from the man's hand, he tossed it up and down experimentally.

"Anything goes as long as I stay within the circle?" Izuku asked, a single eyebrow raised in question.

"That's correct." The teacher replied.

"Cool." Izuku said, his eyes moving to scan over his classmates before finally settling on his target. "You." He said, pointing directly at Uraraka.

"Me?" She asked, pointing at herself in confusion.

“Yep. Come’er for a sec.”

She looked nervously over at Aizawa’s towering form, searching for a sign of disapproval. Finding none, she apprehensively jogged over to where Izuku stood.

“Could you touch this for me?” Izuku asked kindly, extending his hand out to place the ball in front of her. She looked unsure, once again eyeing their teacher nervously before placing 5 fingers on the ball as requested.

“Thank you!” Izuku smiled gratefully, before turning forward once more and throwing the ball easily into the air. Everyone watched as it floated away into the stratosphere. ]

An amused smirk crossed Aizawa’s face as he turned his machine once more, presenting a glowing infinity symbol to the class of hero hopefuls. The class immediately erupted into disapproving exclamations.

“That’s not fair! He didn’t even use his own quirk!” The boy with spiked red hair and sharp teeth yelled.

“That shouldn’t count at all!” A girl with pink skin stomped frustratingly.

“Quiet!” Aizawa roared. “That’s enough.”

The group quieted down, still pouting at the seemingly unfair display.

“Midoriya, What were my rules?” The man continued, addressing Izuku while still keeping his eyes on the class.

“Anything goes as long as I stay within the circle.” Izuku replied easily.

“And do you have a quirk that would have aided you in this test?” Aizawa asked.

“No I do not.” Izuku replied again.

“A quirk is nothing more than a tool that can be used to aid you; A tool that will not always be useful in every situation. Rather than attempt to throw the ball on his own despite knowing he would not score well, Midoriya utilized the help of a fellow student who’s tool was ideal for this challenge. Don’t be mad because he worked smarter than you. He followed my rules, his score stays.” Aizawa finished. The teenagers who’d been voicing their disapproval before blushed in embarrassment at the scolding.

“Moving on.”

With the tests now over, the class began to make their way back towards the locker rooms, having been dismissed for the remainder of the day following the test. As he moved to follow their example, Bakugou was pulled from his thoughts by the graveled voice of his teacher addressing him.

“Bakugou, please stay a moment.” Aizawa said clearly from behind the blonde.

Katsuki froze, a wave of fear washing over him. This was it, Aizawa was going to kick his ass. He gulped nervously, finally turning around to face the intimidating form of the hero.

“The boy you told me about at the entrance exam, I’m assuming you were talking about Izuku correct?” The man said, his tone not giving a single emotion away as he glared down at Katsuki.

“Yes sir.” Katsuki replied shakily.

“And I assume he’s told you of our relationship?” Aizawa asked. Katsuki nodded in confirmation. He felt weak, for feeling so terrified of the man in front of him. He needed to get his shit together. ‘Show him you’ve changed!’

“I didn’t know you were the ‘Kacchan’ he’d told me about when I met you that day, and I admit if I had you probably wouldn’t be standing here right now.” Aizawa stated bluntly. Katsuki winced. “However.” He continued. “Izuku has asked me to give you a chance. He says you've changed, and after our previous conversation and watching your behavior today, I'm inclined to believe him.”

Katsuki’s eyes widened in surprise. He’d been expecting to be expelled, maybe even pounded by the father of his former victim.

“So, despite my better judgment, I’m going to give you the chance to prove to me that I am not making a mistake by allowing you to continue here.” Aizawa said. “But.” Yep there was always a but. “If I ever hear that you hurt him again. If Izuku ever expresses even the slightest bit of discomfort with you being here, I will expel you without hesitation. Consider this a probationary period.” The hero finished. His eyes bore into Katsuki’s frozen form, waiting for the boy's response.

“I…Thank you.” Katsuki finally whispered, his head turning down to stare at the dirt on his scuffed shoes. “I don’t deserve this.”

“Maybe not. Doesn’t change that this is what Izuku wants. He’s always been too forgiving for his own good.” Aizawa said, a fond lilt slipping briefly into his tone as he spoke of his sons neverending kindness.

An emotion Katsuki couldn’t describe flooded through him upon hearing that it was Izuku’s wish that he stay. He was still processing that Izuku was even alive at all, let alone attending UA alongside him just as they’d always dreamed of. His mom was going to flip out. A fear still permeated through him though, the thought of potentially ruining this second chance he’d been granted despite his mistakes.

“I can’t promise I won’t mess up.” Katsuki began softly. “I’m aggressive and temperamental, it’s just part of who I am. But I swear, I will never hurt Izuku again if I can help it!” He declared.

“It’s disgusting that it took me believing he was dead to realize what a dick I was. I hate myself every day for not getting my head out of my ass sooner. My therapist says that I shouldn’t dwell on my past mistakes though; that I should just keep working to make sure I

do better moving forward.” Katsuki said, missing Aizawa’s raised eyebrow upon hearing he was in therapy.

“I know it’s not enough, but I’m trying.” Katsuki finished.

There was a lull of silence as Aizawa seriously thought about the words Katsuki had spoken.

‘I’m trying.’ How many people in Bakugou’s position could say they were even doing that much?

“It’s enough. For now.”

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